

2024



Sony Music Entertainment (Japan) Inc.

Sony Music Entertainment Japan Standardizes Security Using AWS Security Hub

Learn how Sony Music Entertainment Japan improved its security posture using AWS Security Hub.

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Standardized security processes

for 300+ AWS accounts

Reduced



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Streamlined

AWS account management

Enhanced

Maintained

status



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As [Sony Music Entertainment Japan](#) (SMEJ) grew, it faced the challenge of scaling up as well as safeguarding its expanding digital infrastructure. As the music production and distribution company continued to diversify and expand its number of Amazon Web Services (AWS) accounts, inconsistencies in security protocols began to emerge.

After its parent company issued new cloud governance guidelines in 2018, SMEJ built a scalable, cost-effective solution on AWS. SMEJ Guardrail is a comprehensive security framework powered by [AWS Security Hub](#), a service that automates AWS security checks and centralizes security alerts across the organization. By standardizing its security processes, SMEJ not only streamlined cloud security governance but also improved scalability and cost efficiency.



Opportunity | Using AWS Security Hub to Power a Standardized Security Framework for SMEJ

Founded in 1968, SMEJ is a subsidiary of Sony Group Corporation. The company is involved in domestic and international music production, distribution, and artist management, as well as a range of entertainment businesses. With such a large and diverse business, SMEJ struggled to maintain standard security processes among its teams. Business units across the organization had different approaches to security measures.

Having used AWS since 2009, SMEJ's increasing adoption of cloud technology has led to a sprawling AWS environment with more than 300 accounts. Each business unit within SMEJ had its own approach to security when developing new services or managing AWS accounts. This fragmented landscape made it difficult to generate reports or standardize security protocols.

Whereas one team might implement a robust security solution for its website, another team might implement basic security protections and become vulnerable to security issues. Some teams did not store log files from [AWS CloudTrail](#)—a



service that monitors and records account activity across AWS infrastructure—for the required period. To strengthen its security posture, SMEJ needed a way to standardize security practices across all of its entities and accounts.

“Our AWS account management was fragmented,” says Shigeki Wakasa, deputy executive information security officer at SMEJ. “We needed to consolidate our account groups and adopt a unified approach—so we created SMEJ Guardrail.”

Solution | Managing Security at Scale for 300+ AWS Accounts with SMEJ Guardrail

SMEJ Guardrail is a security and resource configuration compliance solution tailored for SMEJ’s vast AWS estate. Using SMEJ Guardrail, the company can maintain standard security measures across its AWS accounts and validate that each account adheres to cloud governance guidelines established by Sony Group Corporation. The initial development and implementation of SMEJ Guardrail took about 3 months; during this time, AWS provided technical support and consultations to aid SMEJ’s journey.

The foundation of SMEJ Guardrail is AWS Security Hub, a unified security service that centralizes and prioritizes security findings across various AWS services. AWS Security Hub assesses the company’s AWS resources against established best practices and industry benchmarks, such as the Center for Internet Security and AWS Foundational Security Best Practices. These best practices encompass a range of checks, from proper encryption settings to detecting suspicious activities. As a cloud security posture management solution, AWS Security Hub performs these best practice checks automatically. With this capability, SMEJ can detect potential vulnerabilities and deploy remediation actions as necessary. The company has also implemented automated remediation mechanisms to promptly address security threats.

With SMEJ Guardrail, the company can standardize its security processes and therefore maintain a uniform security layer across its AWS accounts. SMEJ can also view the results of its threat detection and compliance checks across its organization in a central place, gaining better visibility into the health of its AWS estate. “By performing centralized management and visualization using AWS Security Hub, we were able to standardize our security levels, which had varied for each AWS account,” says Wakasa.

SMEJ Guardrail also uses [Amazon GuardDuty](#) to monitor accounts for suspicious activities and [AWS CloudFormation](#) to track account actions across AWS and support audits and governance. Using [AWS CloudFormation](#)



which speed up cloud provisioning with infrastructure as code—SMEJ can also adapt and expand its security protocols as needed.

The framework’s benefits extend beyond standardized security. In particular, AWS security services are much more cost effective than external providers, which helps reduce the cost of SMEJ’s entire security portfolio. “We only deploy first-party services, so we do not have to pay license or usage fees,” says Tomoyuki Shirakawa, director of SMEJ. “And by using managed AWS services, we can keep our costs down while maintaining optimal availability and performance.”

With an infrastructure-as-code approach and AWS CloudFormation templates, SMEJ can scale horizontally to expand its digital infrastructure as demands grow. And by using AWS-managed services, SMEJ can make sure that its solutions adhere to AWS best practices and benefit from recommendations given by the AWS team. Furthermore, creating a programmable infrastructure has directly boosted staff productivity. Instead of having to navigate technical challenges, SMEJ’s teams can now shift their focus onto core tasks, which has optimized operations so that teams can deliver security results more efficiently.

Outcome | Operating More Securely in the Cloud Using AWS Services

Using AWS Security Hub, SMEJ has created a standardized system to streamline security management across its AWS estate. SMEJ Guardrail is now being used across more than 300 AWS accounts and helps protect 1,300 websites launched by its teams. Moving forward, AWS Security Hub will continue to be an integral part of SMEJ’s cloud security governance.

“By using AWS services and solutions, we have realized many benefits, from better scalability and enhanced productivity to optimal cost effectiveness,” says Yusuke Tashiro, vice president of SMEJ. “We look forward to improving SMEJ Guardrail and enhancing our security capabilities on AWS in the future.”

About Sony Music Entertainment Japan

Sony Music Entertainment Japan is a subsidiary of Sony Group Corporation. Founded in 1968, it oversees domestic and international music production, distribution, and artist management.

AWS Services Used

AWS Security Hub

AWS Security Hub is a cloud security posture management (CSPM) service that performs security best practice checks, aggregates alerts, and enables automated remediation.

[Learn more »](#)



Amazon GuardDuty

Amazon GuardDuty is a threat detection service that continuously monitors your AWS accounts and workloads for malicious activity and delivers detailed security findings for visibility and remediation.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS CloudFormation

AWS CloudFormation lets you model, provision, and manage AWS and third-party resources by treating infrastructure as code.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS CloudTrail

AWS CloudTrail is a service that enables governance, compliance, operational auditing, and auditing of your AWS account.

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